Bookmark Sync — cheat sheet

Chrome is the master copy and is never written to. Chromium, Edge and Firefox are kept matching it by a background service that starts at login and checks every 60 seconds. Version 1.3.3 · github.com/ne0busin3ss/Python/tree/main/Bookmark_Sync

Service control

Do this	Command
Is it running? (press **q** to exit)	`systemctl --user status bookmark-sync`
Start it	`systemctl --user start bookmark-sync`
Stop it for now	`systemctl --user stop bookmark-sync`
Restart it (after an update)	`systemctl --user restart bookmark-sync`
Start at every login (already on)	`systemctl --user enable bookmark-sync`
Stop starting at login	`systemctl --user disable bookmark-sync`
Is it set to start at login?	`systemctl --user is-enabled bookmark-sync`

Always include **--user** (the service runs under your account; no sudo). **stop** lasts until your next login or reboot; **disable** keeps it from starting at login but doesn't stop it if it's already running.

Checking what it did

Do this	Command
Last 20 lines	`journalctl --user -u bookmark-sync -n 20`
Everything today	`journalctl --user -u bookmark-sync --since today`
Watch live (Ctrl+C to stop watching)	`journalctl --user -u bookmark-sync -f`
Only Edge lines	`journalctl --user -u bookmark-sync --since today | grep Edge`

Running the script by hand (from ~/Development/Python/Bookmark_Sync)

Do this	Command
Show detected browsers, open or closed	`python3 bookmark_sync.py --list`
Preview changes, write nothing	`python3 bookmark_sync.py --targets chromium,edge,firefox --dry-run`
Preview every change (no 8-item limit)	`… --dry-run --all`
Sync once right now	`python3 bookmark_sync.py --targets chromium,edge,firefox`
Recover bookmarks only a browser had	`python3 bookmark_sync.py --rescue edge (or chromium / firefox)`
Show all options	`python3 bookmark_sync.py --help`

Good to know

Situation	What to expect
A browser is open	Logged once as "is open — will check it when it closes"; it is updated as soon as you close it
After a reboot	Starts automatically when you log in and checks all browsers right away
Edge settings	Keep **Favorites** off at `edge://settings/profiles/sync` so Edge's own cloud copy doesn't compete with Chrome

Reading a dry run

Symbol	Meaning
+	In Chrome, missing from this browser — will be added
-	**Only in this browser — will be deleted** (saved to an importable file first)
>	Same bookmark in a different folder — moved to Chrome's folder
~	Same link, different name — renamed to Chrome's name
↕	Folder put back in Chrome's order
≠	Folder has a different number of copies of a bookmark

Updating to a new version

```
cd ~/Development/Python/Bookmark_Sync
git pull
systemctl --user restart bookmark-sync
```

Sending your own changes to GitHub

```
cd ~/Development/Python
git add Bookmark_Sync
git commit -m "Describe the change"
git push
systemctl --user restart bookmark-sync
```

Or in VS Code: Source Control → message → **Commit**, then click the **↑1** next to **main** in the bottom-left status bar. Sign-in is handled by `gh auth login` (already done).

Getting removed bookmarks back into Chrome

Step	What to do
1	Find the file: `~/.bookmark_sync/backups/removed/` or a `~/rescued-bookmarks-*.html` from **--rescue**
2	In Chrome open `chrome://bookmarks` → ⋮ (top right) → **Import bookmarks** → choose the file
3	Drag the ones you want into place and delete the rest — the service copies them to the other browsers

Where things are kept

What	Location
Backups (newest 10 per browser)	`~/.bookmark_sync/backups/<browser>/`
Deleted bookmarks, importable (newest 10 per browser)	`~/.bookmark_sync/backups/removed/`
Full log file	`~/.bookmark_sync/sync.log`
Service settings	`~/.config/systemd/user/bookmark-sync.service`
The code (your git folder)	`~/Development/Python/Bookmark_Sync/`

After editing the service settings file, run `systemctl --user daemon-reload` and then restart the service.